



Case Study – Callum: Clues Suggesting Communication Needs

1. Understanding Language

Clues:

- Callum struggled to interpret figurative language and open-ended questions in class, indicating difficulty processing abstract or complex language.
- He misinterpreted his peers' jokes or teasing, assuming they were mocking him, suggesting challenges with understanding nuanced language.
- Instructions like "be more responsible" or "be accountable for your actions" didn't seem to register, as Callum repeated the same behaviours, and he becomes angry, implying difficulty with comprehending abstract vocabulary words such as "responsible" and "accountable".

2. Emotional Literacy Skills

Clues:

- Callum was unable to engage in behaviour support sessions meaningfully, often shrugging off questions about his feelings or actions, suggesting challenges with recognizing and regulating emotions.
- He couldn't articulate the emotions behind his outbursts or behaviours during peer mediation, indicating difficulty identifying and labelling emotions.

3. Inferencing and Verbal Reasoning

Clues:

- Callum struggled to explain cause-and-effect relationships, such as how his actions might lead to specific outcomes (e.g., his behaviour in class led to conflicts or sanctions).
- He had difficulty reasoning through social situations, often assuming others were cruel or mocking him, rather than considering alternative explanations for their behaviour.



4. Narrative Skills

Clues:

- When asked to recount incidents, Callum gave vague, disorganised, and inconsistent accounts. These were hard for staff to follow and often omitted key details.
- His retellings of events would change between attempts, suggesting difficulties with sequencing and maintaining a coherent story.

5. Social Problem-Solving

Clues:

- Callum often misinterpreted social cues, assuming hostility from peers where none may have existed, which escalated conflicts.
- He struggled to articulate his perspective during peer mediation and to propose solutions, leaving conflicts unresolved.
- His inability to reflect on the impact of his actions or to suggest constructive ways forward indicates limited skills in navigating and resolving social challenges.